

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of practical legal experience at BCLP, including six months in Real Estate Disputes and six months in International Arbitration, alongside current client-facing advisory work at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. Experienced in document review, electronic hearing bundles, lease and title research, matter file management and deadline tracking across competing matters. Familiar with iManage and electronic court filing portals. Interested in developing this background in a transactional real estate and real estate finance context.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, carrying partial funding toward the undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Reviewed documents and prepared electronic hearing bundles across leasehold, landlord and tenant, rights of light and easements matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on property issues including easements, leasehold obligations and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials; managed court filings and hearing arrangements
- Prepared client notes; maintained matter records via iManage; tracked deadlines and cost comparisons across several concurrent matters
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents with competing deadlines across multiple files

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the sole junior supporting the team ahead of a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters end to end across housing, employment, welfare benefits, debt and consumer law: takes detailed factual statements, identifies legal and evidential issues, drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and meets submission deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria; identifies evidential gaps; researches complex legal points
- Maintains confidential case records and advises clients on procedural requirements, translating complex rules into clear practical guidance

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis and document review; electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence drafting**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, matter file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters